**GUKESH DOMMARAJU**
*Youngest world chess champion, at India Today Conclave 2025*

**"I'm really glad that I could do this for my parents. They did not allow me to realise...but they did go through a lot of financial struggles"**



BANDEEP SINGH

50TH ANNIVERSARY

**SPORTS**
**2015-2025**

# WORLD CHAMPS

**Indian sport moved faster, reached higher and grew stronger—breaking free of cricket's shadow and carrying its momentum toward bigger arenas**




**For a nation long hypnotised by the crack of willow on leather,** the last decade sounded a different note. The first stirrings came in Rio 2016, where a young P.V. Sindhu smashed her way to Olympic silver, then returned from Tokyo (2021) with bronze and a world title in between (2019).

Old dogged companions—wrestling and boxing—kept the cadence. On the mat, Sakshi Malik, Bajrang Punia, Ravi Dahiya and Aman Sehrawat extended the tradition forward on the Olympic stage, even as